

	Leave Policy		
		Version	HRLP24-2
		Effective Date	1-Apr-2024
	This version supersedes all previous versions with a lesser version number		

1.0 OBJECTIVE: Leave is a period of rest and relaxation provided at intervals during work periods. For convenience in terms of reference, it is divided into categories such as Privilege Leave (PL), Casual Leave (CL), Sick Leave (SL) and other special leaves (Joining, paternity etc) This policy defines the eligibility and processes for the various types of leave across Group businesses*

2.0 DEFINITIONS:

- 2.1 Leave Year:** The Leave Year is the calendar year from 1 January to 31 December. All calculations of earning, credit, availment, balance etc. of leave will be done with respect to each Leave Year
- 2.2 Entitlement:** This refers to the amount, or the number of days of Leave (of different types) that an employee gets in a Leave Year as part of conditions of service, subject to certain conditions such as full attendance on full salary. For example, the entitlement of PL is 21 days in a Leave Year
- 2.3 Earning:** This refers to the rate at which an employee is entitled to earn Leave by the organisation.
- 2.4 Credit:** This refers to the amount of Leave that is credited to the employee's Leave account. E.g an employee earns PL @1.75 days for every month of service rendered
- 2.5 Availment:** Utilisation of the Leave credit is availment. An employee can avail leave provided they have Leave credit and the leave applied for has been approved
- 2.6 Sanctioning Authority:** Usually the Reporting Manager of the employee or any person authorized by the organisation to grant leave to an employee as per the delegation of authority
- 2.7 Employees joining/ leaving in the middle of a Leave Year**
In such cases, leave (PL, SL and CL) will be calculated on pro-rata basis from the date of joining till the end of the Leave Year or from the beginning of the Leave Year till the date of employee exit in units of half a month.
- 2.8 Special Leave:** In addition, an employee may be entitled to leave under specific conditions such as Parental Leave (Maternity/ Paternity), Special Leave on joining or transfer, Sabbatical Leave, etc.
- 2.9 Working day basis:** All leaves will be considered on a 'Working Day' basis, i.e. whilst counting the number of days for any applied leave, holidays or weekly offs that precede, succeed or intervene within its duration, shall not be counted
- 2.10 Public Holiday:** Every year, ten public holidays are declared by businesses for the relevant locations to incorporate local customs. Businesses/locations can choose to give two optional holidays out of ten holidays to make the policy more inclusive. Employees will have the option to choose two holidays from the list of Optional holidays (published by HR SSC at the start of the calendar year). This number is independent of the date of joining. Employees will have to choose their preferred holidays from the proposed optional holiday. If Optional

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ENTITLEMENT: **PRIVILEGE LEAVE 21 DAYS CASUAL LEAVE 7 DAYS SICK LEAVE 7 DAYS**
Entitlement per Leave Year

holidays are not chosen by any employee in a given year, those holidays will lapse for the year.

3.0 TYPES OF LEAVE (S) AND ENTITLEMENT

- 3.1 **Privilege Leave** is the Leave that an employee earns for the services rendered. Therefore, an employee does not earn PL for the period he or she is absent
- 3.2 **Casual Leave** can be availed at short notice towards personal work or exigencies
- 3.3 **Sick Leave** is meant to be availed to recover/ recuperate from illness or for medical treatment
- 3.4 An employee can avail leave which is credited to him/her. However, the sanctioning authority may reject the request (other than Sick Leave) in cases of business exigencies. In such cases, the reasons for refusal need to be recorded in writing and the employee has a right to appeal to the higher authority
- 3.5 **Deviations:** All deviations from the Leave rules / leave for any other reason will require the approval of the Business Head / CEO/ Service Head.
- 3.6 **Special Leave:** This is related to work or personal events such as Long Illness/ Joining/ Transfer or Parental Benefits like Paternity/ Maternity/Adoption etc.
- 3.7 **Exit Leave:** This leave is provided on the last working day of resigned employees to be free from any work priorities and to complete the exit formalities including but not limited to No Dues Clearance (NDC) and related sign-offs, handover of ID cards, electronic assets such as laptop and computer accessories etc.
- 3.8 Absence from work on working days without sanctioned leave is a misconduct

4.0 CASUAL LEAVE (CL) POLICIES & PROCEDURES

- 4.1 CL is credited in advance at the beginning of the year. For those joining in the middle of a Leave Year, the calculation of CL earning will be pro-rata from the date of joining
- 4.2 CL can be availed in units of ½ day.
- 4.3 Unavailed CL will not be carried forward and will lapse at the end of the year.
- 4.4 On transfer to a new unit/ relocation within a unit, un-availed CL will be transferred to the new unit

5.0 SICK LEAVE (SL) POLICIES & PROCEDURES

- 5.1 SL is credited in advance, at the beginning of the year. For new joiners, it will be credited on a pro-rata basis for the period from the date of joining to the end of the Leave Year
- 5.2 SL can be availed in units of ½ day. The company (Business HR) at its discretion may request for and validate/ verify a medical certificate. Any SL request

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beyond the accumulated balance shall be considered as special leave and will require approval from Business Head / CEO.

- 5.3 SL can be accumulated without any limit.
- 5.4 SL can also be combined with PL / Maternity Leave (where applicable) in the case of prolonged illness. This will be subject to the submission of medical certificates
- 5.5 The company may at its discretion refer an employee to further medical check-ups from its approved panel of doctors in addition to validating, through its own sources, any medical certificate submitted

6.0 PRIVILEGE LEAVE POLICY

- 6.1 **Credit:** PL is credited to the employee's Leave account at the end of each Leave Year i.e. on the 1st of January of the next Leave Year
- 6.2 **PL utilisation & Carry forward:** Employees with a full credit of 21 days at the beginning of the year, are expected to take a minimum of 11 days of PL through the leave year. In any case, a maximum of 10 days of the current year eligibility can be carried forward at the end of the leave year and any additional unavailed PL from the current year eligibility will lapse in the Leave Year following the year in which PL was due.
- 6.3 **Maximum Leave:** Balance at the credit of an employee at the beginning of any Leave Year cannot exceed 63 days.
- 6.4 As a special case to ease transition, all employees with a leave balance of more than 63 days as on 1st April 2024, will need to utilise the excess leaves by 31st December 2026
- 6.5 PL can be availed in units of ½ day.
- 6.6 **Advance PL:** Employees may request PL in advance through appropriate channel. Since, PL is an earned leave, the availed advance PL will be settled against the PL balance that will be credited in next leave year.

7.0 PRIVILEGE LEAVE PROCEDURES:

- 7.1 Wherever Leave is credited and availed in advance of the entitlement or earning, it will be recovered from the employees upon their leaving the services of the company unless they have earned that leave
- 7.2 Departmental / Section Heads may require employees to plan their availment of PL in advance to avoid work disruption
- 7.3 Where an employee does not, partially or fully, avail the minimum PL for the year, the amount of PL not availed will lapse

Scenario	Minimum utilisation	Maximum carry forward
Employee has 21 days added at the beginning of the year	11	10

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Scenario	Minimum utilisation	Maximum carry forward
Employee has between 10 and 21 days added at the beginning of the year (new joinee/ on unpaid leave in the previous year)	eligible days minus 10	10
Employee less than 10 days added at the beginning of the year (new joinee/ on unpaid leave in the previous year)	-	Entire balance

- 7.4** Unavailed PL can be carried forward to the next year. The entitlement for the current year is added to the balance leave reflecting in the Leave account subject to a maximum of 63 days of PL
- 7.5** Minimum PL to be availed: PL can be availed subject to a minimum of ½ day.
- 7.6** Encashment of PL balance will only be on Separation

8.0 PATERNITY LEAVE:

- 8.1** Employees can avail maximum 6 days per child as paid paternity leave during the tenure with the group.
- 8.2** Paternity leave should be used within one month of the date of birth of the child.
- 8.3** Paternity leave may be combined with either CL or PL.
- 8.4** Paternity leave is not encashable.